

Right Noise, color, and exotic smells characterize Phnom Penh's busy markets

Below Beautifully firm, translucent chunks of fish are suffused with subtle flavors in Cambodian *amok*



A Day in Phnom Penh

In addition to enjoying Khmer food, Phnom Penh is a great place to sample all things delicious and Gallic. Start the day with filtered coffee and fresh croissants or baguettes in one of the French-style eateries in and around Sisowath Quay on the Tonle Sap riverfront.

MORNING After breakfast, cross the road to the river bank and stroll down to the **Central Esplanade** in front of the glittering campus that is the **Royal Palace**. Then walk next door to the **National Museum**. This important storehouse holds artifacts and statuary from every region of Cambodia, including much from the glorious era of Angkor.

AFTERNOON Take a cyclo (bicycle rickshaw) ride to **Psar Thmei** (Central Market) — a magnificent, French Art Deco behemoth built in 1937. Head back to the **Tonle Sap** and enjoy a gentle river cruise as the sun sets behind the other of the city's buildings.

EVENING Finish the day with a display of classical Khmer Apsara dancing at the Bopha Penh Titanic Restaurant on **Sisowath Quay**.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Phnom Penh International Airport is about half an hour from the center of town by **taxi**. One can navigate the city by **motorcycle taxi** (risky but fast) or by three-wheeled “tuk-tuk.”

WHERE TO STAY

Goldiana (inexpensive) is a spotlessly clean and well-run Chinese hotel popular with visiting journalists and aid workers. www.goldiana.com
Villa Langka Hotel (moderate) is a stylish boutique hotel in a quiet and leafy setting. www.villalangka.com

Raffles Hotel Le Royal (expensive) is a glorious old French colonial hotel with real history and charm. www.affles.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.tourismcambodia.com

